

ZTA Proctor Guide

Reference answers (cheat sheet) + scoring rubric for each use case, integrated. **Do not show to participants.**

How scoring works. Each use case is worth **100 points** across three criteria. Grade each team's submission against the reference answer below; award partial credit generously where intent matches. A team's leaderboard score is the sum across all use cases they submit. Use Cases 1–3 are required, 4–5 are bonus.

Scoring rubric (applies to every use case)

CRITERION	MAX	WHAT EARNS THE MARKS
Pain-point → product mapping	40	Each customer pain point is mapped to an appropriate Cisco product/feature that genuinely addresses it. Full marks = every pain point covered with the right platform and a clear reason; award partial credit per pain point correctly matched.
Products — how & why / differentiators	30	For each proposed product: a correct one-line “how it works” and a convincing “why it fits”. Cisco differentiators (SGT/TrustSec, pxGrid / Rapid Threat Containment, ISE AI profiling, Secure Workload) earn the top of the band.
Diagram & overall solution	30	Diagram is legible and labels every group, marks the enforcement point(s), and traces at least one flow end-to-end. Overall solution is coherent and satisfies the requirements without over-buying hardware.

Use Case 1 — Managed Environment — Segmentation

Required

100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Prior segmentation failed. VLANs/IP subnets complex and tedious.	Implement SGTs over VLAN/IP subnets.
Profiling labour-intensive; staff can't keep up with new devices.	ISE cloud AI profiling.
Failing PCI audits.	Apply SGT for segmentation and insert FW services where L7 security is required.
Corporate PCs not running latest AntiVirus / OS updates.	Use ISE Posture and remediate out-of-date PCs.
No budget for more firewalls to do segmentation.	Use SGTs to enforce segmentation within the wired/wireless network.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
ISE	Authenticate and profile every user and device (web, 802.1X, MAB).	Visibility and scalable.
ISE-SGT	Assign an SGT to each group (Employee, IoT, Desktop-mini, Internet).	Cisco innovation; dynamic policy, topology-independent; end-to-end segmentation into multicloud data centers.
ISE SGT ACL policy	Granular access policy.	SGACL more efficient than IP ACLs.
ISE pxGrid	pxGrid / Rapid Threat Containment; shares context with the ecosystem.	Cisco innovation, RFC8600; dynamically quarantines threat devices; integrates with ACI, FW, SNA, SD-WAN, CSW, switches, routers.
Catalyst SD-WAN	pxGrid integration for unified security policy via C3 / Security Cloud Control.	Consistent policy across the WAN fabric.
FMC / SCC / FTD	Threat detection/protection (NGIPS, malware, content filtering) and source/dest SGT policy enforcement.	Integrates with ISE via pxGrid for Rapid Threat Containment; dynamic SGT-based enforcement.

Use Case 2 — Use Case 2

Required

100 pts

Reference answer to be added when this use case goes live. Score sheet below is ready to use.

Score sheet

[illegible]

Use Case 3 — Use Case 3

Required

100 pts

Reference answer to be added when this use case goes live. Score sheet below is ready to use.

Score sheet

[illegible]

Use Case 4 — Use Case 4

Bonus

100 pts

Reference answer to be added when this use case goes live. Score sheet below is ready to use.

Score sheet

[illegible]

Use Case 5 — Use Case 5

Bonus

100 pts

Reference answer to be added when this use case goes live. Score sheet below is ready to use.

Score sheet

TEAM	MAPPING / 40	PRODUCTS / 30	DIAGRAM / 30	TOTAL / 100

Zero Trust Access Design Clinic — Proctor Guide (confidential). Reference answers reflect Use Case 1; 2–5 to be completed.